

Prepared From Path Lesson

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Raise the question of what it means to grow by showing a concrete case of a living thing that changes size over its life.

Look closely at the frog's story. It begins as a tiny tadpole, just hatched from an egg in the water. It is small, with a tail for swimming and no legs yet. Over time, the tadpole grows legs and its tail disappears. Its body changes shape and size. By the end, it becomes a full-sized frog that can hop onto land.

Think about the very beginning and the very end of this story. What do you notice about how the frog has changed from the tiny tadpole that hatched from the egg to the full-sized frog it becomes? Describe what you see that is different.

Think about what you already know: some things around us are alive, and some things are not. Plants and animals are both alive.

A frog begins life as a tiny tadpole that hatches from an egg. Later, it becomes a full-sized frog.

Look at the tadpole and the full-sized frog in the picture. Are they alive or not alive?

Share your answer with a partner and explain how you know.

Build the definition of growth and connect it to the idea that growing is something living things do, using the anchor to make the idea concrete.

Growth is the process by which a living thing gets bigger over time. The tiny tadpole that hatches from the egg becomes a full-sized frog. This change in size shows real growth.

The tiny tadpole that hatched from the egg is alive. One way we can tell is by watching it grow. At first, the tadpole is very small. Over time, its body gets bigger, its legs appear, and it slowly changes into a full-sized frog. This kind of change is called growth.

Growth means a living thing gets bigger over time. The tadpole does not just get larger all at once. It grows little by little as it eats and develops. The small hatchling becomes a larger tadpole, and that tadpole becomes a full-sized frog. This steady increase in size is growth.

The frog is alive, and its growth is evidence of life. Living things grow in this way. Seeing the tadpole become a full-sized frog helps us know the frog is alive. Growth is one sign that something is a living thing.

Growth is an increase in size in a living thing. This means that growth is not just any change in size—it happens in living things as they develop. A clear example of growth as evidence of life is the tadpole becoming a full-sized frog.

The tadpole changes from a tiny hatchling into a full-sized frog. This increase in size is growth, and it shows that the frog is alive. Living things grow in this special way as part of their life.

Show the learner that not everything that appears bigger has grown. Put the anchor beside a near-miss nonliving case so the boundary of the idea is visible.

A tadpole becomes a full-sized frog by growing. Its body makes new parts and its cells multiply, so the frog truly changes size as a living thing.

A balloon can also look bigger when air is pushed into it, but the balloon itself is not growing. More air fills the space inside, stretching the balloon from the outside instead of building new body material.

These two cases show an important difference: living things increase in size because their own bodies grow, while nonliving things may only appear bigger when something is added to them.

A student adds water to a bowl of dry beans. The beans swell and become larger. Which statement best explains whether this shows growth?

- a.** It does not show growth, because the beans only absorb water and do not develop new cells or structures.
- b.** It shows growth, because the beans get bigger, and getting bigger is always growth.
- c.** It shows growth, because the beans are changing in a way that is the same as how living things grow.
- d.** It does not show growth, because beans never change size.

Check whether the learner can now use the concept to decide when growth is evidence of life, directly addressing the misconceptions the lesson confronted.

A student watches a puddle form as ice melts on a warm sidewalk. Which observation would be evidence of growth in a living thing?

- a.** The puddle spreads wider as more ice melts into water.
- b.** A seedling nearby develops new leaves and a taller stem.
- c.** The sidewalk feels warmer in the afternoon sun.
- d.** The puddle gets bigger, so it must be growing.